

Royal Society University Research Fellowship (URF) Briefing

13 August 2018

Dr Becca Burns

Environment Domain

Royal Society URF Scheme: Deadline 5 September 3pm

For outstanding scientists in the UK who are in the early stages of their research career and have the potential to become leaders in the field

Offers the opportunity to build an independent research career

Extremely competitive- 8% success rate

UCL currently has 27 URFs predominantly working in areas associated with evolution/ organismal biology, computing, ecology, astronomy/ physics, neurosciences/ physiology, engineering/ instrumentation and earth sciences

You can find out more about the projects undertaken by existing URFs on the Royal Society Research Fellows Directory online

<https://royalsociety.org/fellows/research-fellows-directory/>

Applicant Eligibility

Applicants must:

- Have a PhD, applicants who have just submitted their PhD will not be considered.
- Be at an early stage of their research career with between three to eight years of actual research experience since their PhD
- Not hold a permanent post in a university or not for profit research organisation.
- Not hold or previously have held a nationally competitive fellowship that provides an opportunity to establish an independent research group and therefore independent researcher status.
- All nationalities are welcome to apply- however you are responsible for any visa arrangements- Research and Innovation talent visa

Research Eligibility

The proposed research must:

Be within the Royal Society Biological and Physical Sciences remit

This is divided into 9 sectional committees:

- Pure and applied mathematics and computer science
- Astronomy and physics, theoretical physics and applied physics
- Chemistry, applied chemistry and theoretical chemistry
- Engineering, technology, instrumentation, materials science and experimental fluid dynamics
- Earth sciences and environmental physical sciences
- Biochemistry, structural biology and molecular cell biology
- Developmental biology, genetics, immunology, microbiology and experimental medical microbiology
- Anatomy, physiology, neurosciences, health and human sciences
- Organismal biology, evolutionary and ecological science

Must be held at a UK University or research institute

What you can apply for:

Funding is initially provided for 5 years
Fellowships start from 1 October 2019

Value and support provided:

80% of the research fellow's salary costs (must not exceed £40,354.58), directly allocated costs (inc estate costs) and indirect costs under the FEC model.

Research expertise including:

- Research assistance 80% FEC of a PD/PDRA
- 100% research expenses including consumables and travel
- 4 year new PhD studentship (2 year contribution)
- Equipment- check the advice around the necessary contributions if this exceeds £10,000 (inc VAT)
- Public engagement- something the RS are really keen on
- Training

Application Process

- Round opens and applications are filled in via flexi-grant
- HoD and nominated referees submit their support via flexi-grant
- Host Organisation's approver submits their approval via flexi-grant
- Deadline 5 September 3pm. Non submissions are rejected
- Eligibility checks. Initial office based rejections
- Selection process: shortlisted by URF selection panel. Panel rejections
- Independent referees score and comment on the proposals
- Interviews held around April
- Final decision at Selection Panel Meeting in May

Application hints and tips

- Individually **craft the proposal** to reflect its suitability against the Royal Society scientific remit
- **Don't just copy and paste chunks of other fellowship applications**, ensure the questions are answered appropriately
- Provide a strong justification for **independence** and give evidence
- Consider **public engagement** and how you will get your research out there
- Keywords- **use relevant over arching fields and more specific words**- also use the area of the selection committee your research fits
- **No jargon!** The selection committee is made up of a wide range of fellows and relevant researchers/ RS Staff. It is likely this will not include experts in your field. Make the application easy to read, explain acronyms etc. Pay careful attention to the lay terms explanation

Application hints and tips continued....

- If including references use key ones and include up to date references to reflect the **timeliness** of the project
- Make sure you have an **ORCID** identifier and that your profile is up to date
- Where it says up to 3 publications always give 3 if possible
- Royal Society looks to spread URFs across the Sectional Committees- some areas are more under subscribed eg astronomy, engineering, mathematics and computing
- “Under-represented groups are particularly encouraged to apply”
- If using animals make sure you read the Royal Society statement on this <https://royalsociety.org/topics-policy/publications/2006/animals-research/>
- **Make sure you check up on your referees and HoD**
- **Remember the 3pm deadline!**

Flexi-grant

All applications must be submitted online via the flexi-grant system. Any special arrangements need to be highlighted to the URF grants team URF@royalsociety.org

Any issues with the flexi-grant system welcome to check with me or contact the above email

You must register and ensure you fill in all the contact information correctly. Give a most up to date email and periodically check your spam folder

You can login/ register here: <https://grants.royalsociety.org>

Once logged in ensure you select the correct scheme to apply for

Provide answers to all the questions where applicable and particularly where marked with an * as these are compulsory

You can log in and out and complete your application over a number of days, make sure you save your progress

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Application Portal

Logged in as [b.burns@ucl.ac.uk](#) (Registered User)

My account

My contact details

My applications

Summary

University Research Fellowships 2019

URF/R1191177

Dr Rebecca Burns

University College London (UCL)

0% complete

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Print form Download as PDF

View instructions

Once you have completed all sections of the application form and all participants appear as complete on the participants tab, the **'Submit for approval by host organisation'** button will become available on this summary page. Once you click on the **'Submit for approval by host organisation'** button you will be prompted to confirm that you wish to submit your application. Once submitted, you will be able to log in and view your application but you will not be able to modify it. The application form will be passed to an approver in your host organisation to review.

Please note that your contact details must also be complete in the **'Contact Information'** section of the application form before your application form can be submitted. The **'Contact Information'** information section of the application form also includes **'Diversity monitoring questions'** that must be completed. You can access the **'Contact Information'** section of the application form by clicking on the **'Edit Contact Details'** button below.

Questions marked with an * are mandatory, which is typically the majority of the questions.

Application Participants **3** Edit Contact Details

Number	Page	Est. time to complete	Status	Required documents
1	Eligibility Criteria	5 mins	Not Started	Start
2	Contact Details	5 mins	Not Started	Start
3	Applicant Career Summary	10 - 15 mins	Not Started	Start

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3	Applicant Career Summary	10 - 15 mins	Not Started	Start
4	Research Proposal	1 - 2 hrs	Not Started	0 / 1 Start
5	Use of Animals in Research	5 - 40 mins	Not Started	Start
6	ODA Compliance	2 - 60 min	Not Started	Start
7	Financial Details	30 mins	Not Started	Start
8	Applicant Declaration	5 mins	Not Started	Start
9	Head of Department Support	30 - 60 mins	Not Started	0 / 1 Invite Head of Department
10	Nominated Referee (1)	30 - 60 mins	Not Started	0 / 1 Invite Nominated Referee (1)
11	Nominated Referee (2)	30 - 60 mins	Not Started	0 / 1 Invite Nominated Referee (2)

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Application

Participants **3**

Edit Contact Details

To complete and submit your application form you are required to provide supporting statements from up to **three** individuals (including your Head of Department and nominated referees). Using the table below, please invite **three** individuals to provide these references.

The Research Support role is optional, it allows you to invite an individual from the relevant UK Host Organisation research support team to review and amend the application prior to submission. The primary purpose is to ensure that the requested finances have been recorded correctly for this specific grant programme.

Please refer to the relevant scheme guidance notes for further details:

[URF Scheme Notes](#)

▼ Collaboration requests: Active, Pending or Required

Role	Assigned	Status	
i Nominated Referee (1)		Required	Invite
i Nominated Referee (2)		Required	Invite
i Head of Department		Required	Invite
i Research Support		Optional	Invite Not required

Flexi-grant hints and tips

- Make sure HoD and referees are registered on flexi-grant
- Provide advanced warning to your participants, warn them in advance that they will receive correspondence from the Royal Society- periodically check the spam filter
- Ensure you remind participants to mark their work as complete and click submit
- Provide answers to all questions especially those with an *
- Any queries **do not** use the grants@royalsociety.org included on flexi-grant use URF@royalsociety.org
- Read the instructions provided on flexi-grant and download the notes- have these open as you complete each section
- Stick to the word count
- <https://support.flexigrant.com/support/home> can help with technical issues

Any initial queries send them to Becca b.burns@ucl.ac.uk by 12 noon Friday 17 August as we will compile these and then share the answers around

Give yourself plenty of time to complete the online application and plenty of warning to anyone who will need to complete any sections

Deadline 3pm Wednesday 5 September- give yourself enough time!

Remember you have to submit this for approval by your organisation- give them enough time! Speak to your departmental administrator

The deadline is for the complete submission, not the submission to your departmental administrator